

A CITY THAT WORKS

A citizens' framework for Victoria 2026. Proven ideas. Measurable results.

acitythatworks.ca

Version 1.9.2

Every measure costed and sourced

THE PROBLEM IN 30 SECONDS

31%

operating budget growth
in three years

9.34%

residential tax rise in 2026,
not the 7.28% headline

\$750

policing per resident,
the highest in BC

61

missing-middle permits
in 2024, target was 150

Four consecutive years above inflation plus population growth, every one of them closed with one-time measures rather than structural savings. No competitive benchmarking. No zero-based reviews. No published household bill. Victoria does not need to spend more. It needs to spend smarter.

It is a spring evening in 2030 and you are walking down Pandora Avenue on purpose. The lights stay on until morning and nobody is watching you walk home. Unsheltered homelessness is down by half. Your tax notice came in June with one number on it you understood, and it went up by about inflation. Your kids still live here, because twelve thousand homes got built and enough of them were the kind a family can actually use.

VICTORIA IN 2030, IF THIS FRAMEWORK IS DELIVERED

WHAT WE WOULD DO

FOUNDATION

- Government-to-government working tables** with the Songhees and the Esquimalt Nations, on a standing quarterly cadence. Not a gesture, an operating relationship.

LIVEABLE

- 12,000 net new homes by 2030**, with composition targets: 25% missing middle, 20% three-bedroom or larger. Composition is the problem, not volume.
- Published permit times.** Simple under 6 weeks, complex under 6 months, rezoning under 9 months. Plus a pattern book of pre-approved designs and an amnesty for the suites that already exist.
- Childcare and family doctors.** Fast-track permits and below-market City space for both. First-hour free parking, and a walking city with a published sidewalk gap inventory.

SAFE

- Bylaw enforcement 6 AM to 10 PM, seven days**, funded by managed-competition savings rather than by raising taxes or raiding reserves.
- One Downtown Public Order Team.** Police, bylaw, sanitation and outreach under a single command, with a dashboard published weekly.
- Unsheltered homelessness cut in half**, capacity first and enforcement second, with a programme that frees supportive units rather than only adding to them.
- Relentless with the dangerous, compassionate with the vulnerable.** 24% of all 2022 police calls came from 19 addresses. Reclaim the Inner Harbour, the Pandora corridor and Beacon Hill Park.

BEAUTIFUL

- Smart LED streetlights.** No City cameras, no audio surveillance, no behavioural AI. Better lighting cuts crime about 14% on its own.
- Heritage protected**, street furniture restored, Bastion Square pedestrianized, 5,000 trees and a canopy target of 35% by 2035.
- One signature public space**, chosen by residents from three costed options and approved at a referendum before a shovel moves.

WELL-MANAGED

- A tax glide path on the number you actually pay.** 6.5%, then 5%, then inflation plus growth, capped on the residential rate rather than on total revenue.
- Zero-based review of all 200+ programs**, and competitive testing on waste and street cleaning that City crews can win. Workers protected either way.
- The Household Bill.** One published number covering property tax plus water, sewer, solid waste and stormwater, with a five-year forward view.

DEMOCRATIC

- A referendum on every new capital project over \$25M**, and one process for every major project: consult, design, publish the analysis, vote, report. Dowler Place showed what happens without one.
- A quarterly performance dashboard.** Permits, potholes, crime, housing, budget variance, debt per household. Plain language, no spin.
- A lobbyist registry for development files**, no fee to file a freedom-of-information request, an Integrity Commissioner, and council pay changes that take effect only after the next election.

12 COMMITMENTS, MEASURED EVERY QUARTER

1	Residential tax rate	6.5%, 5%, then CPI+growth
2	Verified annual savings	\$8-14M/yr by Year 4
3	New homes, by type	12,000+ net new by 2030
4	Rental vacancy	5%
5	Unsheltered homelessness	down 50%
6	Crime severity	down 15% by 2030
7	Graffiti removed in 48h	90%
8	Permit speed	published target per category
9	Downtown storefront vacancy	11% to 5%
10	Dangerous intersections	top 10 redesigned
11	Transparency delivered	registry, FOI, reports
12	Climate and canopy	-50% GHG, 35% canopy

WHERE THE MONEY COMES FROM

Waste and street cleaning put out to tender	+\$2.4M
Every programme reviewed line by line	+\$3 to 6M
Fewer managers, through retirements	+\$1.9 to 4M
Property tax from 12,000 new homes	+\$8 to 15M
LED streetlights, cheaper to run	+\$0.5 to 1M
Less what everything here costs to run	-\$13.3 to 18M

Left over, every year **\$4.3 to 14.0M**
If everything goes wrong *about -\$0.3M*

WHAT THAT MEANS AT YOUR ADDRESS

The median Victoria home, assessed at \$1,015,000	
Council's 2026 increase	+\$323
The same year, capped at 6.5%	+\$225
Difference, one year, one house	\$98

No projection and no assumed future council: the two rates, the same house, the same year. Your own bill also moves with BC Assessment's valuation, and the cap holds only if the savings above land. If they do not, Year 1 slips and we publish that too.

WHAT THIS IS

Non-partisan and open. Costed, sourced and measurable. Reported every quarter. Free for any candidate to adopt in whole, in part, or as a starting point.

WHAT IT IS NOT

Not a political party. Not a candidate slate. Not City surveillance cameras. Not a machine deciding about a person. Not ideology dressed as policy.